

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ T 6 4
♥ A T 6 4
♦ 6 2
♣ K J 3 2

♠ 9 5 2
♥ 2
♦ A Q T 9 8 7 5
♣ 8 7

N
W E
 S

♠ K Q J 3
♥ J 9 5
♦ K 4 3
♣ Q T 6

♠ A 8 7
♥ K Q 8 7 3
♦ J
♣ A 9 5 4

West North East South

3♦

All Pass
3♦ by North

You dealt this hand.

You estimate you can win 6 ♦ tricks so you open 3♦. Everybody passes.

Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 5 3
♥ Q T
♦ A T 8 7 4 3
♣ J 2

♠ 9 2

♥ K J 8 5

♦ K J 9

♣ K Q 8 3



♠ 7

♥ A 6 4 3 2

♦ Q 2

♣ A 9 7 6 5

♠ K Q J T 8 6 4

♥ 9 7

♦ 6 5

♣ T 4

West

North

East

South

3 ♠

All Pass

3 ♠ by South

The bidding has been as shown.

You have 13 points and if partner had opened with a 1 ♠ bid you'd be feeling "jumpy". But what a preemptive bidder needs from dummy are immediate winners, not points. So you pass.

Here's a pretty good tip: When partner opens with a 3-bid and you are trying to decide whether to take him to game, visualize him holding this very hand: K Q J 10 x x x of trumps and nothing in any other suit. Then base your decision on that.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 6 5 2

♥ -

♦ K 6 3

♣ Q T 8 5 3

♠ A

♥ Q J T 8 7 6 3

♦ 9 7 5

♣ 6 2



♠ T 4

♥ K 9 5

♦ A Q J T 4

♣ J 9 4

♠ J 9 8 7 3

♥ A 4 2

♦ 8 2

♣ A K 7

West

North

East

South

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

You dealt this hand.

You expect your hand to produce 5 ♥ tricks and the ♠ A. So you open 3♥. Partner responds 4♥.

When you preempted 3♥ you described your hand perfectly. You have nothing more to say except pass.

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q J T 2
♥ 6
♦ K Q 5 3
♣ K 9 6 2

♠ A K 7 6

♥ J 5 3

♦ 9 4

♣ A 8 7 4



♠ 9 5 4

♥ A 9

♦ A J T 7

♣ Q J T 3

♠ 8 3

♥ K Q T 8 7 4 2

♦ 8 6 2

♣ 5

The bidding has been as shown.

No matter how much we try to reduce bridge to rules and guidelines we will never get rid of the judgement factor. With this hand you definitely have 3 fast tricks for partner. In theory he can take 6 of his own, so 3♥ should be the right contract. BUT, maybe he could ruff a ♦ in your dummy?

Fortune favors the bold so you bid 4♥ . . . and live happily ever after.

West

North

East

South

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South